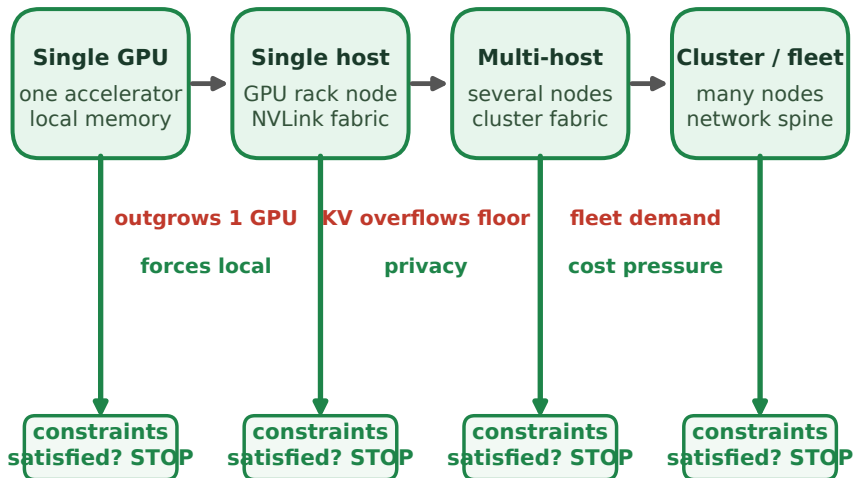


## The reference-architecture escalation path



escalate only when a constraint binds — else STOP; tiers are orthogonal levels of scale, not a ranking